EDIBLE CANDLES — THE GOURMET COLLECTION

Premium Packaging Guide

Give Your Creations a Finishing Touch Worth Remembering

Table of Contents

1. Why Packaging Matters 4
2. Packaging Materials Overview 5
3. Single Candle Packaging 8
4. Gift Set Packaging 10
5. Seasonal Packaging Ideas 12
6. Eco-Friendly Packaging Options 14
7. Shipping & Transport 16
8. Cost-Effective Packaging 18
9. Packaging Supplies Checklist 20
10. Packaging Quick Reference Card 22

Why Packaging Matters

silent ambassador of your edible candle craft.

You have already done the remarkable work of transforming wax, wick, and flavor into something genuinely extraordinary. The candle looks beautiful, it smells like a patisserie, and it tastes even better. Now consider: the very first thing your recipient sees is not the candle itself—it is the package around it.

First Impressions Are Formed in Seconds

Research on consumer psychology consistently shows that packaging triggers an emotional response before a person even touches the product inside. When someone receives a gift, the outer wrapping sets the stage for everything that follows. Elegant packaging tells the recipient that what is inside is precious, thoughtful, and worth savoring. A plain plastic bag, no matter what treasure it holds, whispers the opposite.

For edible candles, this effect is amplified. Your creation is part confection, part decor, part conversation piece. The packaging should hint at all three.

Perceived Value

Premium packaging elevates perceived value dramatically. Two identical edible candles—one handed over in a grocery bag, the other nestled in tissue paper inside a rigid box with a satin ribbon—will be valued very differently by whoever receives them. The boxed version feels like a luxury gift. The loose one feels like an afterthought.

> **The Golden Rule of Packaging**
> Your packaging should make the recipient pause before opening. That half-second of anticipation is where the magic begins. If they tear it open without a thought, the packaging is not doing its job.

Food Safety Considerations

Unlike a standard decorative candle, your edible candles are meant to be consumed. This creates a unique packaging requirement: the materials that touch the candle must be food-safe. Tissue paper, wraps, and inner linings should be food-grade whenever they make direct contact with the candle surface. This protects flavor integrity and ensures your gift is as safe as it is beautiful.

> **Important Reminder**
> Never use packaging materials that are dyed with non-food-safe inks in direct contact with the edible portions of your candle. Opt for unbleached, food-grade tissue paper or wax paper as the innermost layer.

The Three Functions of Great Packaging

Protect

Shield the candle from temperature, moisture, dust, and physical damage during transport and storage.

Present

Create an unboxing experience that communicates care, craftsmanship, and elegance before the candle is even revealed.

Preserve

Maintain freshness, fragrance, and structural integrity so the candle arrives in the same perfect condition it left your hands.

With these principles in mind, let us explore the materials and methods that will make your packaging as memorable as the candles themselves.

Packaging Materials Overview

mplete look at every option worth considering.

Choosing the right packaging material is a balance between aesthetics, protection, cost, and occasion. Below is a thorough comparison of the six most popular options for edible candle packaging. Each has its strengths, and the best choice depends on your intended use.

Rigid Gift Boxes

PREMIUM

Sturdy, stackable, and inherently luxurious. Rigid boxes with magnetic closures or lift-off lids offer excellent protection and an upscale unboxing experience. They hold their shape beautifully and can be lined with tissue paper or satin.

Pros: Maximum protection, high perceived value, reusable by the recipient.

Cons: Higher per-unit cost, bulkier for shipping, requires more storage space.

Cost Level: $$$

Best For: Premium gifts, special occasions, luxury retail.

Glass Jars

ELEGANT

Clear or tinted glass jars let the beauty of the candle show through while providing airtight protection. They preserve freshness exceptionally well and feel substantial in the hand.

Pros: Airtight seal, visual display, reusable, food-safe.

Cons: Heavy, breakable during shipping, limited to candle sizes that fit the jar opening.

Cost Level: $$–$$$

Best For: Farmers markets, display gifts, candles meant to be stored before use.

Kraft Paper & Boxes

ARTISAN

Natural brown kraft paper and kraft boxes evoke a handcrafted, artisanal aesthetic. They pair beautifully with twine, dried flowers, and stamped labels. Lightweight and affordable.

Pros: Eco-friendly, inexpensive, easy to customize, rustic charm.

Cons: Less structural protection, can look informal for high-end occasions, absorbs moisture.

Cost Level: $

Best For: Casual gifts, craft fairs, eco-conscious recipients, large batches.

Clear Cellophane Wrap

VERSATILE

Transparent cellophane bags or sheets let the candle speak for itself. A ribbon or twist tie at the top completes the look. Simple, effective, and suitable for nearly any occasion.

Pros: Affordable, showcases the candle, easy to use, available in food-grade options.

Cons: Minimal protection from impact, limited insulation, can look basic if not accessorized.

Cost Level: $

Best For: Party favors, markets, quick wrapping, see-through presentation.

Decorative Tins

STURDY

Metal tins with hinged or press-fit lids offer excellent protection and a satisfying tactile quality. They come in round, square, and rectangular shapes, and can be purchased in a wide range of finishes.

Pros: Durable, reusable, excellent protection, premium feel.

Cons: Heavier, can dent, limited visibility of the candle inside, moderate cost.

Cost Level: $$

Best For: Holiday gifts, travel-friendly candles, multi-use packaging.

Small Wooden Crates

BOUTIQUE

Miniature wooden crates or boxes deliver a unique, farmhouse-chic aesthetic. They double as decor after the candle is enjoyed. Often filled with shredded paper or excelsior for cushioning.

Pros: High novelty factor, sturdy, reusable as decor, excellent for gift sets.

Cons: Bulky, expensive per unit, heavy for shipping, may need a liner for food contact.

Cost Level: $$$

Best For: Gift sets, subscription boxes, premium corporate gifts.

Quick Comparison

MATERIAL	PROTECTION	PRESENTATION	COST	ECO-FRIENDLY
Rigid Gift Boxes	Excellent	Luxurious	$$$	Moderate
Glass Jars	Excellent	Elegant	$$–$$$	High (reusable)
Kraft Paper & Boxes	Basic	Artisan	$	High
Cellophane Wrap	Minimal	Simple/Versatile	$	Low–Moderate
Decorative Tins	Very Good	Premium	$$	High (reusable)
Wooden Crates	Very Good	Boutique	$$$	High

Mixing Materials

The most striking packaging often combines two materials—for example, a kraft box with a cellophane window, or a glass jar inside a rigid box with tissue paper. Do not feel limited to a single material.

Single Candle Packaging

Single Candle Packaging

ep-by-step method for wrapping individual candles beautifully.

Wrapping a single edible candle is the fundamental skill of this guide. Master this process, and every gift you give will leave a lasting impression. The method below works for any candle shape and adapts to any occasion.

What You Will Need

- [ ] One rigid box or kraft box (sized to fit your candle with 1–2 cm clearance on each side)
- [ ] Food-grade tissue paper (2–3 sheets)
- [ ] One ribbon or twine (approximately 60 cm / 24 inches)
- [ ] One label or tag (handwritten or printed)
- [ ] Optional: a sprig of dried lavender, a cinnamon stick, or a small dried flower for garnish
- [ ] Optional: food-safe wax seal for the tissue paper closure

The Wrapping Process

1. **Prepare the Box.** Place one sheet of tissue paper inside the box so it lines the bottom and drapes over the sides. The paper should be large enough to fold back over the candle once placed. If using a rigid box, crumple a small piece of tissue paper and place it beneath the liner to create a gentle cushion.

2. **Wrap the Candle.** Take a second sheet of tissue paper and lay it flat. Place the candle in the center. Gather the paper upward around the candle, gently twisting the top closed. This inner wrap protects the candle surface and adds a layer of discovery to the unboxing.

3. **Nestle the Candle.** Lower the wrapped candle into the lined box. The candle should sit snugly without sliding. If there is excess room, tuck a small roll of tissue paper alongside to prevent movement.

4. **Close the Tissue Liner.** Fold the excess tissue paper from Step 1 back over the top of the candle. For an elevated touch, apply a small food-safe wax seal to hold the folds closed.

5. **Close the Box.** Place the lid on the box. Ensure it closes smoothly without pressing down on the candle.

6. **Add the Ribbon.** Wrap the ribbon around the box. For a classic look, tie a simple bow on top. For a more modern aesthetic, wrap it horizontally and tie a knot to one side. Trim the ribbon ends at a diagonal for a clean finish.

7. **Attach the Label.** Tuck a handwritten or printed tag under the ribbon or tie it directly to the bow. Include the candle name and a brief note: "Light it, admire it, then enjoy every bite."

8. **Add the Final Garnish.** Slip a dried flower, herb sprig, or cinnamon stick under the ribbon. This small detail elevates the entire presentation from "nice" to "unforgettable."

> **Pro Tip: The Two-Second Test**
> Hold the finished package at arm's length. If it makes you pause and smile within two seconds, you have succeeded. If something feels off, it is usually the ribbon tension or a missing finishing touch.

Single Candle Presentation Styles

The Classic Gift

White rigid box, gold tissue paper, satin ribbon, printed label. This is the timeless approach that works for every occasion. Pair with a single dried rose for weddings or a sprig of rosemary for a garden party.

The Rustic Charm

Kraft box, unbleached tissue paper, natural twine, hand-stamped tag. Tuck a cinnamon stick or a dried orange slice under the twine. Perfect for autumn gatherings and farmers market sales.

The Minimalist

Clear cellophane wrap gathered at the top with a single velvet ribbon. A small tag dangles from the closure. The candle is fully visible and the presentation is effortlessly chic. Best for candles with exceptional visual appeal.

The Boutique Jar

Place the candle in a glass jar, add a circle of wax paper on top, secure with a rubber band, then tie a ribbon over the band to conceal it. Attach a hanging tag. This style preserves freshness beautifully.

Gift Set Packaging

Gift Set Packaging

n duos to six-packs: arranging multiple candles for maximum impact.

Gift sets are where edible candle packaging truly shines. Multiple candles together create a visual story—complementary colors, varied heights, coordinated scents. The key is ensuring each candle is secure, each arrangement is intentional, and the overall effect feels curated rather than crammed.

The 2-Pack Duo

The duo is an intimate pairing. Choose two candles that contrast or complement each other—perhaps one sweet and one savory, or one tall and one short.

1. **Select a box** with interior dimensions that allow both candles to sit side by side with approximately 2 cm between them and 1 cm from the box walls.
2. **Create a divider.** Cut a strip of cardboard the height of the box and fold it into an accordion shape. Place it between the candles to prevent contact during transport.
3. **Wrap each candle individually** in a half-sheet of tissue paper before placing them in the box. This protects surfaces and adds an extra layer of discovery.
4. **Fill the gaps** with crinkle-cut paper or shredded tissue. The candles should not shift when the box is gently tilted.
5. **Finish** with a wide ribbon wrapped around the box and a label that names both candle varieties.

The 4-Pack Collection

Four candles arranged in a square or 2x2 grid create a perfectly balanced presentation. This is the most popular gift set size.

1. **Use a box with internal dividers** (four equal compartments) or create your own by cross-cutting two strips of cardboard and interlocking them at the center.
2. **Line each compartment** with a small square of tissue paper in an accent color that complements the candle it will hold.
3. **Place each candle** in its compartment. Alternate colors diagonally for visual balance—if two are light and two are dark, place matching shades in opposite corners.
4. **Add a description card** on top of the candles, beneath the tissue paper closure. List each candle by name with a one-line tasting note.
5. **Close and ribbon** as with the duo, but consider a cross-ribbon (both horizontal and vertical) to emphasize the four-square layout.

The 6-Pack Deluxe

Six candles arranged in a 2x3 or 3x2 grid deliver a generous, impressive gift. This is the format for holidays, corporate gifting, and luxury experiences.

1. **Choose a deeper box** to accommodate extra cushioning. A rigid box with a hinged lid or a two-piece box works beautifully at this scale.
2. **Build a grid divider** with five strips of cardboard: two long (lengthwise) and three short (widthwise), interlocked to create six compartments.
3. **Cushion the base** with a full layer of crinkle-cut paper or cotton batting before inserting the divider. Each candle should sit slightly above the rim of its compartment so they are visible when the lid is lifted.
4. **Arrange by gradient.** Place candles in order from lightest to darkest, left to right, top to bottom. This creates a cohesive visual flow.
5. **Include a tasting card** printed on card stock, listing all six candles with brief descriptions. Tuck it under the ribbon on top of the box or place it inside a small envelope resting on the candles.
6. **Finish with a wide satin ribbon** and a wax seal on the knot for a genuinely luxurious feel.

> **Cushioning Golden Rule**
> When the box is closed and gently shaken, nothing should move or rattle. If you hear shifting, add more cushioning. For edible candles, movement during transport can crack delicate surfaces or transfer scents between pieces.

Gift Set Arrangement Quick Reference

SET SIZE	BOX LAYOUT	DIVIDER STRIPS	RIBBON STYLE	EXTRAS
2-Pack	Side by side	1 vertical	Single wrap + bow	Contrast pair
4-Pack	2 x 2 grid	1 vertical + 1 horizontal	Cross-ribbon	Diagonal color balance
6-Pack	2 x 3 grid	2 vertical + 1 horizontal	Wide satin + seal	Gradient arrangement + tasting card

Seasonal Packaging Ideas

sform your packaging to match the spirit of every season.

Seasonal packaging creates instant emotional resonance. When the wrapping reflects the time of year, the gift feels more intentional and timely. Here are four seasonal themes designed specifically for edible candles.

Winter Holidays

DEC – JAN

Color Palette: Deep forest green, cranberry red, champagne gold.

Signature Elements: A small sprig of fresh or faux pine tucked under the ribbon. A red velvet or grosgrain ribbon tied in a classic bow. A tag printed on dark green card stock with gold lettering.

Tissue Paper: Dark green or deep red, with a sheet of gold tissue layered on top.

Finishing Touch: A single miniature pine cone wired to the ribbon, or a tiny gold bell. The scent of pine mingling with the candle's aroma creates an irresistible first impression.

Box Choice: Rigid box in white or forest green. Alternatively, a red tin with a clear window in the lid.

Valentine's Day

FEB

Color Palette: Blush pink, deep rose, ivory, soft gold.

Signature Elements: A satin ribbon in blush or rose. Scattered dried rose petals placed on the tissue paper inside the box so they cascade out when the lid is lifted.

Tissue Paper: Ivory with a single sheet of blush pink on top.

Finishing Touch: A small wax seal in rose gold on the tissue paper closure. A tag that reads simply: "For you." The restraint is part of the romance.

Box Choice: Heart-shaped rigid box for a duo, or a rectangular box with a satin-lined lid for a collection.

Summer

JUN – AUG

Color Palette: Bright citrus (lemon, tangerine, lime), crisp white, natural linen.

Signature Elements: A linen or cotton ribbon in a natural tone. A dried citrus slice (lemon or orange) tucked under the ribbon. A simple kraft tag with hand-lettered text.

Tissue Paper: White or pale yellow, keeping the look airy and fresh.

Finishing Touch: A small bundle of dried lavender or a sprig of rosemary tied alongside the ribbon. The aesthetic should evoke a sun-drenched garden party.

Box Choice: Light kraft box or a white box with a cellophane window. Cellophane bags with a linen ribbon closure work beautifully for casual summer gatherings.

Autumn

SEP – NOV

Color Palette: Burnt orange, warm brown, deep burgundy, wheat gold.

Signature Elements: A cinnamon stick or two, tied against the ribbon. Burlap or jute ribbon in place of satin. A tag printed on kraft paper with a leaf motif.

Tissue Paper: Warm brown or unbleached natural, with a single sheet of burnt orange for contrast.

Finishing Touch: A small bundle of wheat stalks or a dried maple leaf pressed under the ribbon. The textures—burlap, cinnamon bark, kraft paper—should feel rich and tactile.

Box Choice: Kraft box or a small wooden crate. A burlap drawstring bag works well for single candles in casual settings.

Year-Round Neutral

If you package frequently and prefer a single system, a cream or white rigid box with a gold ribbon and natural tissue paper works for every season. Swap only the garnish element (pine in winter, rose in spring, citrus in summer, cinnamon in fall) to keep things seasonal without restocking entirely.

Eco-Friendly Packaging Options



Sustainability and elegance are not in conflict. In fact, many of the most visually appealing packaging choices happen to be the most environmentally responsible. Here is how to package your edible candles with a clear conscience.

Recycled & Recyclable Materials

The simplest step toward eco-friendly packaging is choosing materials that have already lived one life and can live another.

- **Recycled cardboard boxes:** Available in brown or white, these provide solid protection and print beautifully with stamps or labels.
- **Recycled tissue paper:** Slightly more textured than virgin tissue, which actually enhances the artisanal feel.
- **Soy-based inks:** If you print labels or stamps, soy-based inks are biodegradable and produce rich, vibrant colors.
- **Recycled card stock:** For tags and tasting cards, recycled card stock has a beautiful natural texture.

Biodegradable Wraps

Plant-Based Cellophane

Unlike petroleum-based plastic wrap, plant-derived cellophane is made from cellulose and is fully compostable. It looks identical to conventional cellophane but breaks down in a home composting environment within weeks.

Beeswax Wraps

For candles that will be consumed within a few days, beeswax wraps offer a charming, reusable alternative. They mold around the candle with the warmth of your hands, and the natural wax scent complements many candle fragrances.

Reusable Containers

The most eco-friendly package is one the recipient keeps and uses again. Consider these reusable options:

- **Glass jars with clamp lids:** After the candle is enjoyed, the jar becomes a storage container, vase, or drinking glass.
- **Ceramic ramekins:** Present the candle in a small ramekin. Once the candle is eaten, the ramekin joins the kitchen collection.
- **Fabric pouches:** Cotton or linen drawstring bags can be reused for jewelry, herbs, or small items. Choose unbleached, undyed fabric for the most natural look.
- **Wooden boxes:** Small hinged wooden boxes become keepsake containers, desk organizers, or planter boxes.

Minimal-Waste Strategies

1. **Eliminate unnecessary layers.** If the box itself is beautiful, you may not need both inner tissue and outer wrapping. One layer of protection is often enough.
2. **Use the candle as its own display.** Place it on a small wooden board or slate tile, wrap in cellophane, tie at the top. The "packaging" is also a serving piece.
3. **Skip the filler.** Instead of crinkle paper, use a fitted insert (cut from recycled cardboard) that holds the candle snugly. Zero waste, perfect fit.
4. **Print less.** A hand-stamped tag on recycled paper uses less material and energy than a full-color printed card. It also feels more personal.
5. **Offer a return program.** If you sell regularly, encourage customers to return boxes and jars for reuse. Offer a small discount as an incentive.

The Eco Checklist

Before finalizing your packaging, ask: Can every component be recycled, composted, or reused? If the answer is no for any piece, look for an alternative. The goal is zero waste to landfill.

Shipping & Transport

ting your edible candles from point A to point B in perfect condition.

Edible candles are beautiful but delicate. They are sensitive to temperature, susceptible to fragrance transfer, and can crack or deform under pressure. Proper shipping and transport techniques are essential whether you are carrying a gift across town or mailing one across the country.

Temperature Management

The Critical Rule

Edible candles should be kept between 60°F and 75°F (15°C–24°C) at all times during transport. Above this range, wax softens, shapes distort, and surface details can melt. Below this range, some ingredient-infused waxes may crack.

Warm Weather Shipping

- Include a reusable cold pack wrapped in a paper towel (never in direct contact with the candle).
- Use insulated box liners made of recycled denim or foam.
- Ship early in the week (Monday or Tuesday) to avoid weekend warehouse storage.
- Select expedited shipping: two-day or overnight during summer months.
- Include a "Perishable — Keep Cool" label on the outer box.

Cold Weather Shipping

- Wrap each candle in an extra layer of tissue paper for insulation.
- Use double-walled corrugated boxes to buffer against freezing temperatures.
- Avoid shipping on days when the forecast drops below 32°F (0°C) at the destination.
- Include a hand-warmer packet (separated from the candle by several layers of paper) for extreme cold.
- Include instructions: "Allow to reach room temperature before unwrapping."

Physical Protection

Impact damage is the most common shipping problem. Follow this layered approach:

1. **Individual wrapping.** Wrap each candle in food-grade tissue paper, then a layer of bubble wrap or corrugated cardboard wrap.
2. **Inner box.** Place the wrapped candle(s) in the gift box with dividers and cushioning as described in the Gift Set section.
3. **Outer shipping box.** Place the inner gift box inside a larger corrugated shipping box. There should be at least 5 cm (2 inches) of cushioning material on all six sides.
4. **Fill every gap.** Use crumpled kraft paper, packing peanuts (biodegradable preferred), or air pillows to fill all remaining space. The inner box should not shift at all.
5. **Seal and label.** Tape the outer box securely on all seams. Apply "Fragile," "This Side Up," and "Perishable" labels.
6. **Shake test.** Pick up the sealed box and shake it firmly. If you feel or hear any movement, open it and add more cushioning. Repeat until the box is silent.

Timing Your Shipment

SCENARIO	RECOMMENDED SHIPPING SPEED	PACK COLD PACKS?	NOTES
Local delivery (same city)	Same day / hand delivery	Only if above 80°F	Transport in an insulated bag in your vehicle
Regional (1–3 day ground)	Standard ground	Spring/Fall: No • Summer: Yes	Ship Monday–Wednesday
National (3–5 day ground)	2-day or overnight	Yes in warm months	Avoid Friday shipments
International	Expedited air	Yes (check customs rules)	Verify food import regulations at destination

The Communication Advantage

Include a small card in the shipping box with handling instructions for the recipient: "Your edible candles have arrived! Please unpack within 24 hours and store at room temperature away from direct sunlight." This simple note dramatically reduces the chance of damage after delivery.

Cost-Effective Packaging

tch your budget without sacrificing elegance.

Premium packaging does not require a premium budget. With the right strategies, you can achieve a high-end look and feel while keeping costs firmly under control. The secret is intentional simplicity: invest in one or two hero elements and keep everything else clean and affordable.

Bulk Buying Tips

- **Order boxes in quantities of 25 or more.** Most packaging suppliers offer significant discounts at the 25, 50, and 100 unit thresholds. The per-unit cost of a rigid box drops dramatically when purchased in bulk.
- **Buy tissue paper by the ream.** A ream (480 sheets) costs a fraction of per-sheet pricing and will last through hundreds of candles.
- **Purchase ribbon on spools, not pre-cut lengths.** A 50-yard spool of satin ribbon will wrap approximately 25–30 boxes and costs less than ten pre-cut bows.
- **Standardize your box size.** Using one or two box sizes for all your products simplifies inventory and maximizes bulk discounts. Design your candle sizes to fit your boxes, not the other way around.
- **Buy seasonally in advance.** Holiday-themed ribbons and tissue paper are cheapest in January (post-holiday clearance) and July (mid-year wholesale). Stock up months ahead.

DIY Embellishments That Cost Almost Nothing

Hand-Stamped Tags

A simple rubber stamp and an ink pad transform blank kraft tags into personalized labels. One stamp lasts for thousands of impressions, and a single ink pad handles hundreds. Total investment: minimal. Perceived value: high.

Dried Herb Garnishes

Grow lavender, rosemary, or mint in a windowsill pot. Harvest and dry small sprigs to tuck under ribbons. The cost is essentially zero, the visual impact is significant, and the fresh scent adds a sensory layer.

Wax Seals

A wax seal stamp and a bag of sealing wax beads provide hundreds of seals. Each one takes 30 seconds to make and adds an unmistakable air of luxury. Use on tissue closures, envelope flaps, or directly on ribbon.

Printed Wrapping Bands

Instead of wrapping entire boxes, print a belly band—a strip of paper that wraps around the box middle. It uses 80% less paper than full wrapping, costs pennies per band, and looks intentionally elegant.

Where to Source Materials

You do not need specialty shops for most packaging supplies. Here is where to look:

MATERIAL	WHERE TO LOOK	BUDGET TIP
Rigid boxes	Wholesale packaging suppliers, craft supply stores	Order in white and customize with stamps or bands
Kraft boxes & paper	Packaging wholesalers, restaurant supply stores	Restaurant suppliers often have the best prices
Tissue paper	Wholesale packaging suppliers, party supply stores	Buy reams in white; it matches everything
Ribbon & twine	Fabric stores, craft supply chains, wholesale textile shops	Buy on spools, not pre-cut; choose one signature color
Glass jars	Canning supply retailers, bulk food container distributors	Buy by the case (12 or 24 units)
Labels & tags	Office supply stores, online print-on-demand services	Print on kraft card stock at home for the lowest cost
Dried botanicals	Your garden, farmers markets, dried flower suppliers	Grow and dry your own for zero cost

The One-Splurge Strategy

Pick one element to invest in and keep everything else minimal. A beautiful ribbon on a plain kraft box looks intentional. An elaborate box with an elaborate ribbon and elaborate tissue and an elaborate garnish looks cluttered. Elegance lives in restraint.

Cost Per Package Estimates

PACKAGING LEVEL	COMPONENTS	ESTIMATED COST PER UNIT
Budget	Cellophane bag + ribbon + printed tag	$0.30 – $0.75
Mid-Range	Kraft box + tissue paper + twine + stamped tag	$1.00 – $2.50
Premium	Rigid box + tissue paper + satin ribbon + wax seal + garnish	$3.00 – $6.00
Luxury	Rigid box + satin lining + satin ribbon + printed card + garnish	$5.00 – $10.00

Packaging Supplies Checklist

ything you need, organized and ready to check off.

Print this page and keep it in your packaging station. Before you begin any wrapping session, run through the list to ensure nothing is missing. There is nothing worse than reaching for a ribbon spool that is empty.

Core Supplies

- [ ] Boxes (rigid, kraft, or both) in your standard sizes
- [ ] Food-grade tissue paper (white or cream, plus one accent color)
- [ ] Ribbon (satin, grosgrain, or twine) on spool
- [ ] Scissors (sharp, dedicated to ribbon cutting)
- [ ] Tags or labels (blank kraft tags or pre-printed)
- [ ] Pen or marker for handwritten tags
- [ ] Food-safe wax paper or parchment (for innermost candle contact layer)

Cushioning & Structure

- [ ] Crinkle-cut paper or shredded tissue (for void fill)
- [ ] Cardboard sheets (for cutting dividers)
- [ ] Ruler and craft knife (for precise divider cuts)
- [ ] Cotton batting or fabric scraps (for luxury lining)
- [ ] Bubble wrap or corrugated wrap (for shipping protection)

Finishing Touches

- [ ] Wax seal stamp and sealing wax beads
- [ ] Dried botanicals (lavender, rosemary, dried flowers, cinnamon sticks)
- [ ] Dried citrus slices (for summer packaging)
- [ ] Small pine cones or faux evergreen sprigs (for winter packaging)
- [ ] Rubber stamp and ink pad (if using hand-stamped tags)
- [ ] Tasting cards or description inserts (pre-printed or handwritten)

Shipping Supplies

- [ ] Corrugated shipping boxes (outer box, larger than gift box)
- [ ] Packing tape (clear, heavy-duty)
- [ ] Reusable cold packs (for warm-weather shipping)

- [ ] Insulated box liners (recycled denim or foam)
- [ ] "Fragile" and "This Side Up" labels
- [ ] "Perishable — Keep Cool" labels
- [ ] Packing peanuts or air pillows (biodegradable preferred)
- [ ] Handling instruction cards for recipients

Seasonal Add-Ons

SEASON	ADDITIONAL SUPPLIES
Winter Holidays	Red & green ribbon, gold tissue paper, mini pine cones, small bells, pine sprigs
Valentine's Day	Blush & rose ribbon, dried rose petals, rose gold wax seal, heart-shaped tags
Summer	Linen ribbon, dried citrus slices, lavender sprigs, pale yellow tissue paper
Autumn	Burlap ribbon, cinnamon sticks, dried leaves, wheat stalks, burnt orange tissue paper

Inventory Management Tips

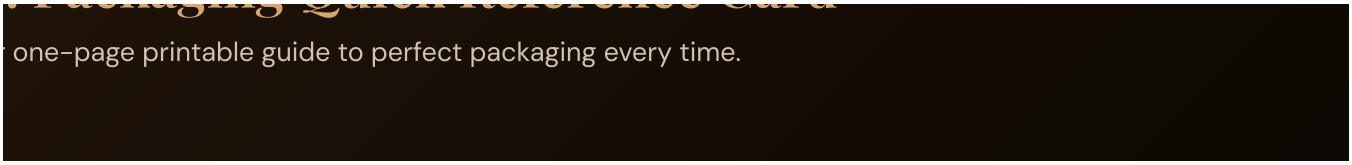
The Minimum Stock Rule

Always keep at least 10 units of every core supply on hand. When you use your last 10, place a reorder immediately. Running out mid-session wastes time and leads to improvised solutions that look rushed.

The Packaging Station

Dedicate a clean, flat workspace to packaging. Store all supplies within arm's reach, organized in bins or drawers. A well-organized station cuts packaging time in half and produces more consistent results.

Packaging Quick Reference Card



Cut along the border and keep this card at your packaging station. It covers the essential do's and don'ts at a glance.

Packaging Quick Reference Card

Edible Candles — The Gourmet Collection

DO

- Use food-grade tissue as the innermost layer
- Cushion every candle individually before boxing
- Include a tasting card or description insert
- Perform the shake test before sealing for shipping
- Store candles at 60–75°F before and during transport
- Use cold packs in warm weather (never touching candle)
- Tie ribbon firmly but without crushing the box
- Add one natural garnish for a finishing touch
- Label shipping boxes as Fragile and Perishable
- Match your packaging to the season or occasion

DON'T

- Use non-food-safe inks or dyes touching the candle
- Leave candles loose in a box without dividers
- Ship on Fridays (risk of weekend warehouse heat)
- Over-decorate: one ribbon, one garnish, one tag
- Use strong-scented materials that overpower the candle
- Reuse shipping boxes with conflicting labels
- Forget to check the forecast before shipping
- Pack cold packs in direct contact with candle surface
- Skip the inner wrapping to save time
- Use plastic wrap in place of food-grade tissue

Quick Packaging Decision Flowchart

IF THE CANDLE IS FOR…	USE THIS PACKAGING	ADD THIS
A close friend (casual)	Cellophane wrap + ribbon	Handwritten tag
A dinner party host	Kraft box + tissue + twine	Dried herb garnish
A birthday gift	Rigid box + tissue + satin ribbon	Wax seal + garnish
A wedding favor	Small rigid box or tin	Monogram tag + flower
A corporate gift	Rigid box + belly band	Printed tasting card
A holiday gift	Seasonal box + themed ribbon	Seasonal garnish
Market / retail sale	Cellophane bag + printed label	Ingredient sticker
Shipping (any distance)	Gift box inside shipping box	Cold pack + handling card

The Five-Minute Packaging Protocol

When time is short, follow this streamlined process:

1. **Wrap** the candle in one sheet of food-grade tissue paper.
2. **Place** it in a pre-lined box (keep boxes pre-lined in batches).
3. **Fold** the tissue over the top.
4. **Close** the box and wrap with a single ribbon, tying a knot (not a bow) to one side.
5. **Tuck** a pre-made tag and a dried garnish under the ribbon. Done.

Remember

Great packaging is not about expense or complexity. It is about care made visible. A simple box wrapped with intention will always outperform an elaborate setup done in haste. Take your time with the details, and your edible candles will be remembered long after the last bite.

♦ ♦ ♦

Your Packaging Journey Starts Now

You have every technique, every tip, and every checklist you need to present your edible candles like the works of art they are. The only thing left is to begin.

Next Step

Return to the main collection to explore your next guide.

EDIBLE CANDLES — THE GOURMET COLLECTION